

The term "technology" in the industrial era meant systems of machinery for production.

In today's post-modern world, technology means something much more. Today it's an all-encompassing system that we actually live within. We're its cogs. Technology transformed from a mere construct of culture to a culture in itself. At the forefront of this culture were geeks, who took to it very naturally. The technocrats of yesteryear became the geeks of today. The two are so closely linked that almost all of geek culture is fully entrenched in its larger set. Hence Geekdom is not just about being into niche technology, it's more of an approach towards things. It's a way of life.

As you go through our list of contemporary cultures you'll find out that it's not simply about what's being consumed that's important, the way that it's consumed is essentially the way of the geek. It's all about being "into" something. You could be into obscure and humour-based coding or fanatically absorbing every bit of information that is released about the second season of *Game of Thrones*, it's all still "geek culture". While navigating the endless mundane wastelands of everyday life you become part of something smaller, something niche and special. You belong to a community of like-minded individuals with their own set of arcane rituals, customs and beliefs. In the rat race you can revel in the knowledge of this group, share a nod of quiet acknowledgement with a fellow geek and be aware of that collective consciousness.

Of course, trying to capture the true essence of any culture is like trying to trap lightning in a bottle; impossible, yes, but we'll surely try to give you a headstart. Geekdom though seemingly impenetrable is in reality fairly inclusive. After all, as Mahatma Gandhi once said "No culture can live, if it attempts to be exclusive."

The creativity clique

Current technology offers various ways through which your creativity can be recognised and rewarded. The theory is simple: make something interesting and chances are it'll get shared

setting off the great viral machine that is the internet. It could be digital art that thrives in pockets such as deviantart.com, creative photography with its own circles (flickr, 500px, Instagram, photo.net and other photo blogs), music composition at SoundCloud or simply creative content on a YouTube channel. Other avenues of geekier creative expression include Pixel Art, a digital art form in which images are painstakingly created at the pixel level, and Mario Paint Composer, a tool that lets you create music using sounds from *Mario*. It's quite astonishing what people are able to create in these forms. (links in bit.ly bundle at the end of this section)

But on any platform there's bound to be competition and there will be a set of norms and rules that the culture follows. Let's look at YouTube, specifically since it's been getting the most attention of late and much of what you create can be "video'ed" and shared on YouTube. Recent statistics reveal that eight years worth of video gets uploaded to YouTube every day. It's obvious you need to stand out. Humour, shock value and vulgar displays of talent are some of the ingredients that cause things to go viral in this culture.



What makes stuff go viral?

What was it with Kolaveri Di then? Sure it's a catchy tune but it's not like there haven't been catchy jingles or self-deprecating South Indian humour before. Maybe the cute girl in the video helped? Yet the key to complete immersion into this culture is consistency. Not meteoric

flash-in-the-pan success. To be a YouTuber a.k.a a part of YouTube's

Partner programme you'll need a successful stream of content rather than just one video. And what do you get? Some estimates suggest that a content partner with 100,000 plus subscribers gets upwards of \$25,000 a year. In the west about 20,000 successful partners have

been brought on board by YouTube which includes biggies such as *nigabiga* and *rwj* to even relatively niche early birds such as *labnol* who rode the success wave. In fact most of these big names have moved from creating videos in basements with webcams to slick production values thanks to Maker Studios, an outfit that has acquired several of these budding YouTubers.

So what's the scene like in our homeland? Content from India that's currently uploaded on YouTube and gets decent number of views is limited to ironic clips of Bhojpuri videos or howlers from news channels. It's mostly unoriginal content. But as any development in the west has a tendency to trickle down to our shores eventually, so will this culture of creating methodically viral content. What we're trying to say is that it won't be long before an Indian *lonelygirl15* bores you to death or a *raju william johnson* captivates millions. In fact, recently YouTube launched the Indian arm of the partner programme. They've got on board YouTuber's such as Shraddha Sharma a.k.a a shraddharockin, a small town girl who uploads videos of her crooning to her guitar. Others include jayhindtv, a late show format online comedy show that's often profane and satirical. So what's their secret sauce and what could be yours? Creativity, consistency and identifying a niche audience. So go ahead make something and join in the culture of creativity. Here's a link bundle to get you started <<http://bit.ly/cultcreate>>

Share it louder

By sharing we don't mean tons of data over P2P and Torrents. That's borderline illegal! And we're pretty sure most of you are already into that culture. What we're talking about here is knowledge sharing. There are several avenues through which communities share knowledge — open-source code, crowdsourced repertoires such as Wikipedia, the user-generated compendium of contemporary language Urban Dictionary and many more.

However, some of you might wonder "if knowledge is power why would I want to share it and lose a bit of that power?". This is indeed a paradox and there are many cultural reasons as to why people engage in this seemingly altruistic behaviour. Ranging from approval and a

